Paweł Mikołajek

Product Designer & Builder

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SUMMARY

Designer who builds. I came up through agency and brand work (Aromen, Webstacks, Ogilvy clients) and joined Human Made in 2022 as its only designer. Since then the job has grown from visual design into shaping and shipping the internal products the team works in: Figma systems and prototypes, motion in After Effects and Lottie, and working front ends built with AI that I direct, review and test.

EXPERIENCE

Visual Designer, Human Made

Aug 2022 - Present

Matlock, UK

- Joined as the agency's only designer and, on my own initiative, grew the role beyond visual design into designing and building internal products end to end (interface, front end and backend) with AI-assisted development in Claude Code.
- Designed and built Sparrow, a PDF review tool in production for the team, with pinned comments, threads resolved in place, and share links to the latest or an exact version (React, PDF.js, TipTap, Express, SQLite).
- Turned the Human Made brand guidelines from a static reference into a suite for people and AI agents: design tokens, editorial voice guidance, an agent skill for Claude Code, Claude.ai, ChatGPT and Slack, and generators for business cards, assets and team diagrams.
- Designed and built Workbench, the marketing team's planning board, to replace their spreadsheets: a month calendar as home, a forward view of the year's campaigns, a content calendar by publishing date, and a drafting room for undated ideas (Next.js, SQLite).
- Created and maintained the central Figma design space for the agency and Altis Cloud, and produced motion and marketing assets.

Creative Designer, Webstacks

Mar 2021 - Aug 2022

San Diego, US

- Worked inside the design department through agile sprints and daily stand-ups.
- Designed UI components and contributed to a broader, multi-product design system.
- Produced vector illustrations in Figma and Illustrator, plus SVG-friendly web animations in After Effects + Lottie.

Multimedia Designer, Aromen BVBA

Jan 2018 - Jul 2022

Wevelgem, Belgium

- Led cross-media projects across branding, illustration, and UI for the Aromen App and webshop (WooCommerce, later Odoo).
- Built a complete label and packaging system across hundreds of product lines.
- Produced 3D mockups, exhibition collateral, signage, and the company's catalogues and decks.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Workbench, Design, Frontend, Backend

2026

A shared planning board for the marketing team, built to replace their spreadsheets. A month calendar is home, with a forward view of the year's campaigns, a content calendar by publishing date, and a drafting room for ideas without a date yet. Next.js, React, TypeScript, Tailwind, SQLite.

Sparrow, Design, Frontend, Backend 2026

Shared PDF review for the team. Pin feedback to the page, reply and resolve in place, and keep the conversation across drafts, with clear links to the latest or an exact version. React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Express, SQLite.

Letter Clash, Design, Frontend, Backend 2025

A real-time multiplayer word game built for the team, with a 20-second turn clock, live ghost tiles from your opponent, and a server that owns the rules. React, TypeScript, Vite, WebSocket, SQLite.

HM Brand Guidelines, Design systems, Frontend, Agent workflows 2024 to present

From a static reference to a brand suite for people and agents. Shared tokens, editorial guidance and practical tools bring Human Made's brand into the conversation and the work. Design tokens, JavaScript, Node.js, Agent skills.

SKILLS

Design	Figma, Design systems, Prototyping, UI components, Iconography, Brand systems
Motion	After Effects, Lottie, SVG animation, Micro-interactions, Storyboards, Motion principles
Frontend	React, TypeScript, Tailwind, Live prototypes, Claude Code
Build	Node.js, Express, SQLite, WebSocket, Vite
AI and systems	Design tokens, Agent skills
Tools	Adobe Photoshop, InDesign, Sketch, Next.js

WORKED WITH

HubSpot, DJI, Human Made, Webstacks, Ogilvy

KIND WORDS

“Pawel is nothing short of a world-class illustrator and designer. His strong work ethic, love of new technology, and helpfulness make him an invaluable team member. I constantly find myself in awe of his work and can never wait to see what next project he works on.”

Nicolas Mansfield, Head of Design, Webstacks

“Pawel is an incredibly detail-oriented designer. I’ve had the pleasure of working with him on a number of projects and he has always delivered exceptional results. The speed at which he works never impacts the quality of his deliverables, and he places the user at the very center of everything he dreams up. An absolute pleasure to work with.”

Elika Dizechi, Marketing Manager, HubSpot

“I worked with Pawel on DJI’s enterprise-insights.dji.com content platform. Pawel led all the web page designs with great sense in graphics as well as his in-depth understanding of my content team’s needs. He responded with valuable feedback and really efficient implementations.”

Hailey Peng, Customer Insights Manager, DJI

“Pawel has done several design projects for us and always done a fabulous job. On time, on budget, and high-quality work. Thoroughly recommend.”

Natalie (Krag) Lyall, Head of Content, Ogilvy Asia